

Budget Tracker — Product Proposal

The only Etsy budget tracker with AI-powered decision intelligence.

Status: Approved — 2026-05-10 | **Tabs:** 12 | **Pricing:** \$12 / \$22 / \$34

Why This Is a Big Opportunity

- **Largest Etsy finance category** — budget templates top search charts year-round
- **January spike** — resolution buyers flood Etsy with high purchase intent
- **Broad audience** — students, families, couples, anyone with income
- Top sellers earn **\$10k–\$20k/month** on this single product
- Apps like YNAB charge **\$109/year** — our one-time sheet undercuts massively
- **AI-enhanced version does not exist on Etsy** — first mover advantage
- Gateway product — customers buy Debt Planner & Sinking Funds next

Core Budgeting Methods Supported

- **50/30/20 Rule** — Needs / Wants / Savings split auto-calculated
- **Zero-Based Budgeting** — every dollar assigned to a category before spending
- **Envelope Budgeting** — virtual envelopes per category, real-time deductions
- **Pay Yourself First** — savings moved to top of budget before expenses

User selects preferred method on setup — sheet adapts automatically.

Sheet Tabs (12 tabs)

Tab	Description
Dashboard	Monthly snapshot: income vs. expenses, savings rate, budget method score, upcoming bills
Income Tracker	All income streams: salary, freelance, rental, side hustle. Per-paycheck allocation
Income Categories	Customizable: Primary Job, Freelance, Rental, Dividends, Side Hustle, Other — all renameable
Expense Tracker	Date, category, vendor, amount, payment method. Budget vs. actual per category
Expense Categories	Pre-built groups: Housing, Food, Transport, Health, Entertainment, Subscriptions, Misc
Credit Card Manager	Up to 6 cards: balance, APR, minimum payment, due date, accruing interest
Emergency Fund	Current balance, monthly contribution, 3-month & 6-month targets, months covered

Savings Goals	Up to 10 goals: target, deadline, monthly needed, progress bar
Bill Calendar	Recurring bills with due dates, amounts, auto-pay status. 60-day forward view
Cash Flow Forecast	30/60/90-day forward view: projected balance, flags danger months
Annual Summary	Full 12-month view with charts: spending by category, savings rate trend
Household Mode	Two-income tracking, shared expense splitting, settlement tracker

Features Borrowed from Professional Competitors

Feature	Source	What It Does
Zero-Based Budgeting Engine	YNAB	Every dollar assigned before month starts; running unassigned total
Paycheck Allocation Tool	YNAB	Split each paycheck across categories as it arrives
Budget vs. Actual Tracker	Monarch Money	Side-by-side planned vs. spent, color-coded variance
Cash Flow Forecasting	PocketSmith	Forward-looking balance projection; flags danger months
Rollover Spending	Copilot	Unused budget rolls into next month's envelope
Subscription Audit	Copilot	All subscriptions with monthly cost, last used, true annual total
Savings Rate Benchmark	Monarch	Your rate vs. national average (3.9%) and FIRE target (50%+)
Break-the-Cycle Mode	YNAB	"Days until next paycheck" countdown + spending budget for the period

Pricing & Tiers

ESSENTIALS

\$12

Simple. Works out of the box.

- Dashboard (monthly snapshot)
- Income tracker + income categories
- Expense tracker + expense categories
- Credit card manager (up to 3 cards)
- Emergency fund tab
- Bill calendar (upcoming 60 days)
- 50/30/20 scorecard
- Annual summary + charts
- Google Sheets + Excel versions
- Setup instructions tab

PRO

\$22

Dark mode. Full control.

- Everything in Essentials
- Dark mode dashboard
- Zero-based budgeting engine
- Paycheck allocation tool
- Budget vs. actual tracker
- Cash flow forecast (90-day)
- Rollover spending per category
- Subscription audit tab
- Up to 6 credit cards
- Savings goals (up to 10)
- Household mode (2 incomes)
- Savings rate benchmark
- Break-the-cycle paycheck mode

AI EDITION

\$34

Your money, with a brain.

- Everything in Pro
- **Smart Spending Advisor** — paste monthly actuals → AI returns 3 ranked spending cuts with exact dollar amounts
- **Scenario Simulator** — "Cut dining \$100/month" → AI models 12-month savings, debt payoff & net worth impact
- **Spending Scripts** — AI-written scripts to negotiate bills and cancel subscriptions
- **Cash Flow Intelligence** — AI flags danger months 60 days ahead with specific fix recommendations
- **Annual Money Review** — year-end AI summary: wins, losses, priorities for next year
- **Category Advisor** — AI suggests categories you are over-allocating vs. industry benchmarks

Upsell & Cross-Sell

- **Gateway product** — "You might also need" tab links to Debt Payoff Planner & Sinking Funds Planner
- **Bundle anchor** — included in All-in-One Finance Bundle (\$97 Pro / \$149 AI)
- **Annual edition model** — "2027 Edition" released each December captures New Year resolution buyers
- **Couple's edition** — standalone variant with household-first layout (separate Etsy listing)
- **Localized editions (future)** — UK/AU/CA versions with local tax brackets and savings benchmarks

Market positioning: One-time \$12–\$34 vs. YNAB at \$109/year, Monarch at \$99/year, Copilot at \$95/year. We capture the audience that wants smart features without subscription lock-in — and add an AI layer no competitor on Etsy or in apps offers as a spreadsheet.